

Helix Robotics Corp. — Company Profile and 2025 Annual Overview

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1. Company Background

Helix Robotics Corp. ("Helix") is a robotics company headquartered in Austin, Texas. It was founded in 2014 by Dr. Maya Okafor and Daniel Reyes, who met while studying mechanical engineering at Carnegie Mellon University. Okafor serves as Chief Executive Officer, while Reyes held the role of Chief Technology Officer until 2021, when he stepped down to chair the company's advisory board.

Before founding Helix, Dr. Okafor worked as a research scientist at Northwind Labs, a Boston-based research institute specializing in autonomous systems. She holds a PhD in robotics from Carnegie Mellon University and was born in Lagos, Nigeria.

In 2021, Priya Natarajan was appointed Chief Technology Officer. She previously led the computer vision team at Orbital Dynamics, a satellite imaging company based in Denver, Colorado. Natarajan reports directly to the CEO.

2. Products

Helix's flagship product is the Atlas-7, an autonomous warehouse robot launched in 2019. The Atlas-7 uses the company's proprietary navigation software, called PathMind, and is manufactured at Helix's assembly plant in Monterrey, Mexico. It can lift loads of up to 500 kilograms.

In March 2024 the company introduced the Atlas-9, which succeeds the Atlas-7 and adds a robotic arm developed jointly with Kessler Automation GmbH, an industrial engineering firm headquartered in Stuttgart, Germany. The Atlas-9 also runs PathMind and is sold primarily to logistics and e-commerce customers.

Helix also offers FleetView, a cloud dashboard that lets customers monitor all of their robots in real time. FleetView is hosted on Microsoft Azure.

3. Customers and Partnerships

Helix's largest customer is Brightcart, an online grocery retailer based in Chicago, Illinois, which has deployed more than 1,200 Atlas robots across 14 fulfilment centres. Brightcart's Chief Operating Officer, Tom Lindqvist, described the partnership as "the backbone of our same-day delivery service."

In 2023 Helix signed a distribution agreement with Sumida Trading, a Japanese conglomerate headquartered in Osaka, giving Sumida exclusive rights to sell Helix products in Japan and South Korea.

The company also partners with the University of Texas at Austin on a research programme into human-robot collaboration. The programme is led by Professor Elena Vasquez, a former colleague of

Dr. Okafor at Northwind Labs.

4. Funding and Ownership

Helix has raised a total of \$410 million across four funding rounds. Its Series C round, closed in 2022, was led by Granite Peak Ventures, a venture capital firm based in Menlo Park, California. Granite Peak partner Lucas Feld joined Helix's board of directors as part of that deal.

Earlier, in 2017, Helix received seed funding from Northwind Labs' venture arm, Northwind Ventures. Sumida Trading made a strategic investment in the company in 2023, at the same time as the distribution agreement.

5. Acquisitions

In September 2025 Helix acquired Lumen Sensors, a LiDAR manufacturer based in Eindhoven, the Netherlands, for \$85 million. Lumen Sensors was founded by Arjen de Vries, who now leads Helix's sensor division. Lumen's LiDAR units had already been supplied to Helix for use in the Atlas-9.

6. Competition

Helix competes with Ostrava Robotics, a Czech company that makes the Kestrel line of warehouse robots, and with Brightline Machines, a subsidiary of Orbital Dynamics. Analysts at Meridian Research rank Helix second in the North American warehouse robotics market, behind Ostrava Robotics.

7. 2025 Highlights

In 2025, Helix reported revenue of \$620 million and employed approximately 2,300 people. The company opened a second assembly plant in Pune, India, which began producing Atlas-9 units in November 2025. Dr. Okafor was named Robotics Executive of the Year by the International Federation of Automation. The company announced that it plans to list its shares on the Nasdaq stock exchange in 2026.